- If bleeding is severe, DO NOT waste time looking for suitable padding, but be prepared to use the patient's hand or your hand to hold the wound together if the patient is unable to do this unaided.



2. Raise the injured area

- If the wound is on a limb, raise it in a supported position to reduce blood flow to the injured area.
- If an arm is injured, you could apply an arm sling or elevation sling.

Try to avoid any direct contact with the patient's blood or other body fluids. Use disposable gloves if possible. If gloves are not available, place your hands inside a plastic bag.

- If there has been any contact with blood or any other body fluids, wash your hands or any blood splashed on the skin thoroughly with soap and water as soon as possible after the incident.
- If you are concerned about a possible risk of infection, obtain advice from your doctor as soon as possible.



3. If a foreign body is embedded in the wound:

- DO NOT remove it but apply padding on either side of the object and build it up to avoid pressure on the foreign body.
- Hold the padding firmly in place with a roller bandage or folded triangular bandage applied in a criss-cross method to avoid pressure on the object.



4. Keep the patient at total rest:

- Even if the injury involves the arm or upper part of the body, the patient should rest in a position of greatest comfort for at least 10 minutes to help control the bleeding.

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